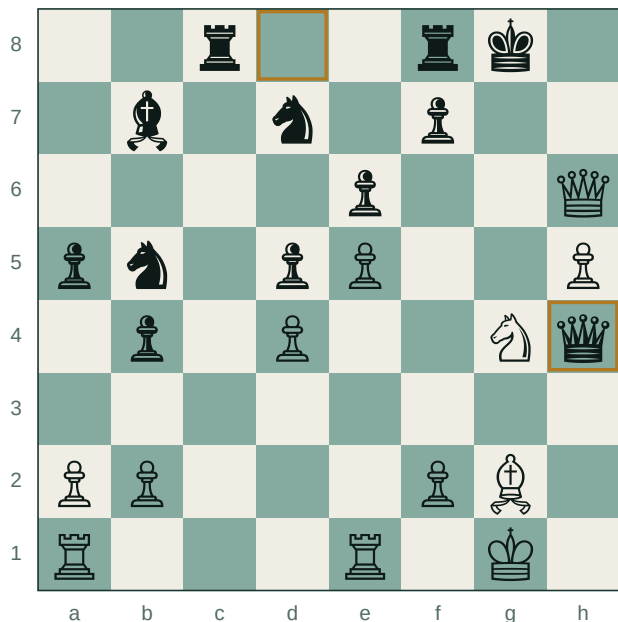


Kingside attacks: White, move 25

Kingside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 24...Qxh4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Nf6+ Nxf6 26. exf6 Qxf6 27. Qxf6

25.Nf6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on g8 and knight on d7. Recorded reply: **25...Nxf6**.

26.exf6 The pawn captures the knight on f6. Recorded reply: **26...Qxf6**.

27.Qxf6 The queen captures the queen on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -2 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on d7 and bishop on b7. Check for tactical protection.